



An Roinn Dlí agus Cirt
Department of Justice

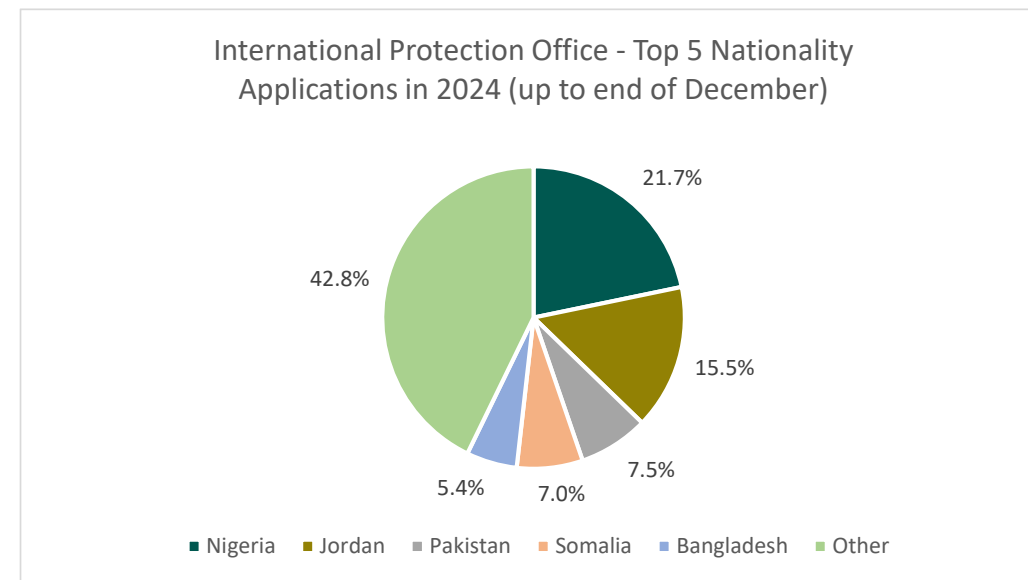
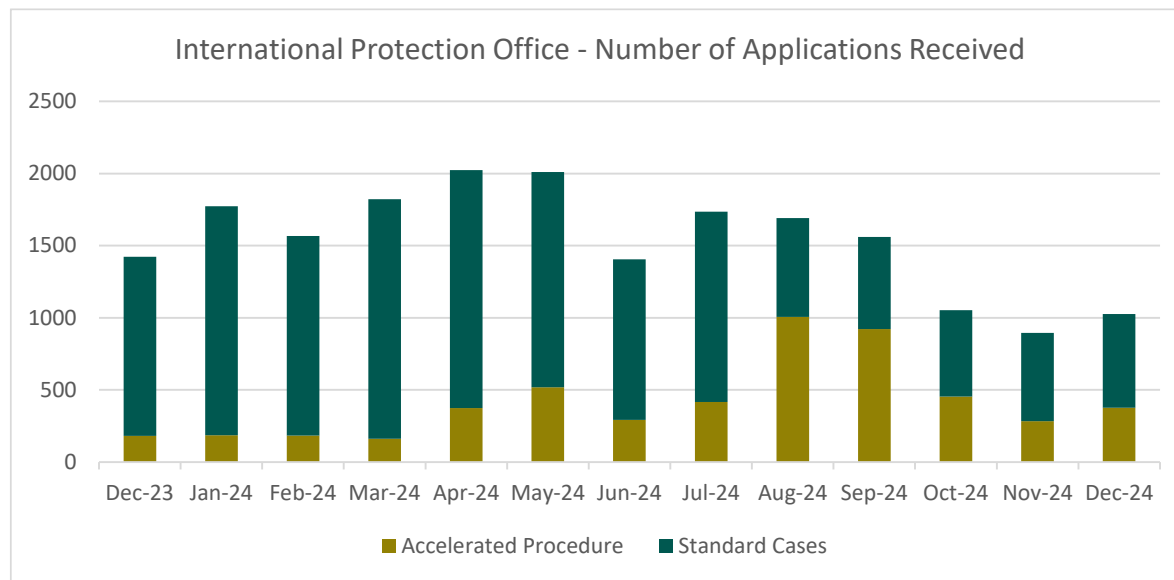
International Protection: December 2024

Executive Summary

The figures in this dashboard were extracted on the 07th January 2025. These are operational figures and subject to change. The charts below refer to key points in the asylum process. A flow chart is provided at the end of the pack that sets out this process. Overall, for December 2024:

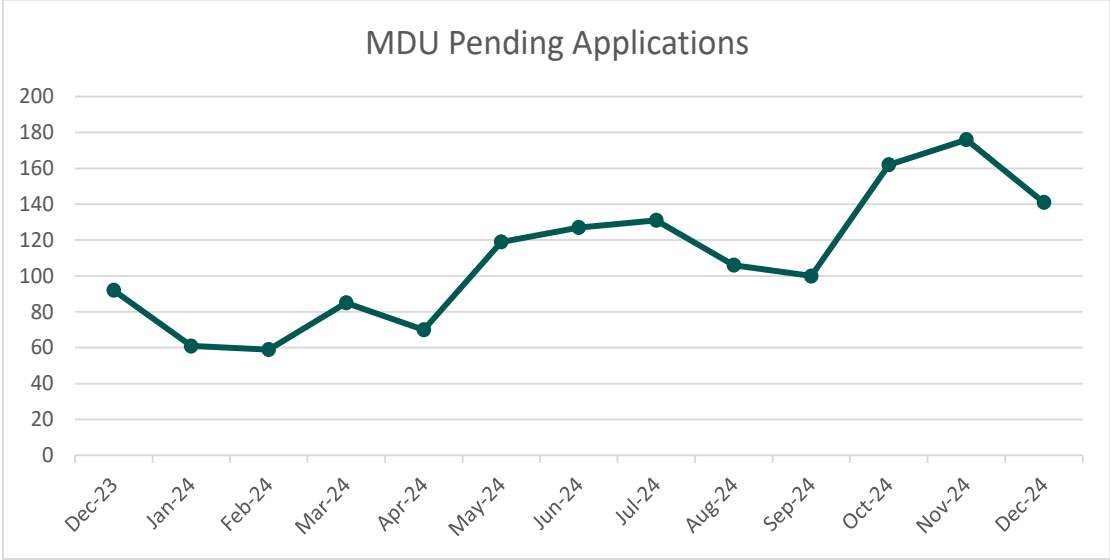
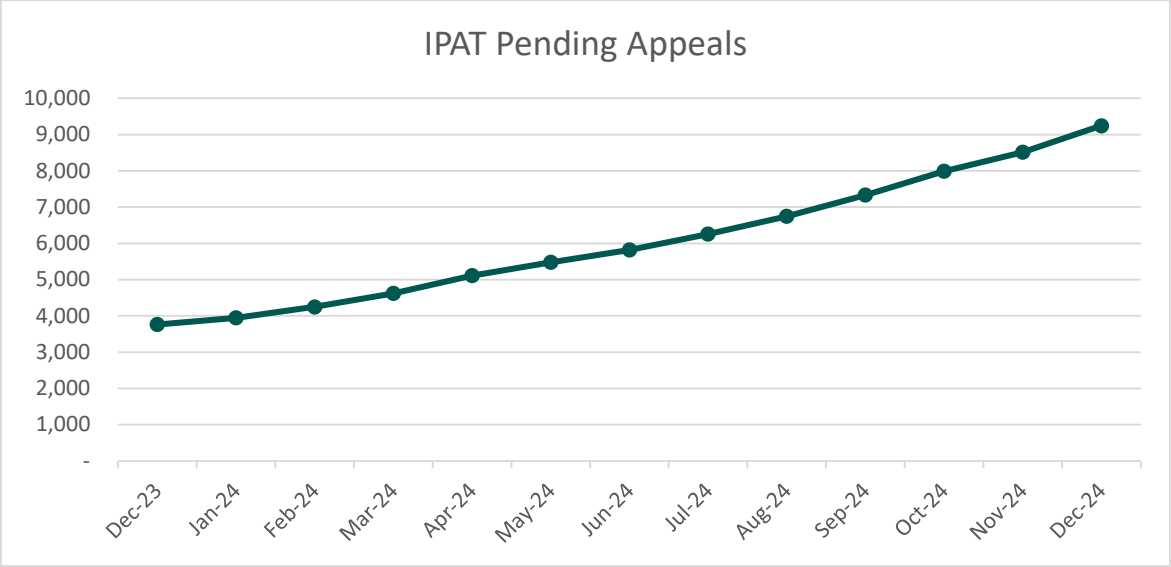
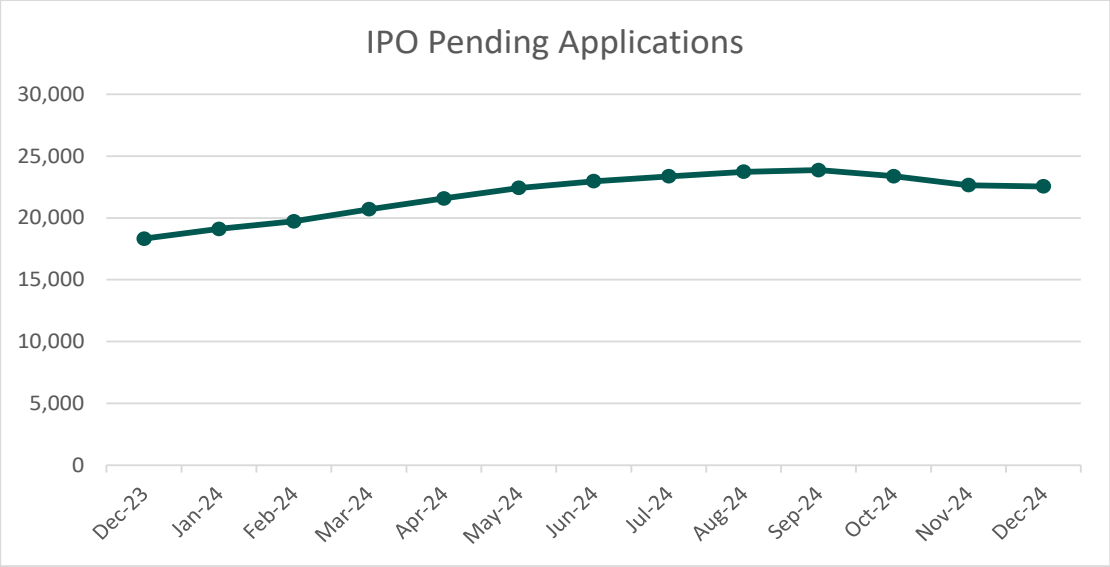
- The number of asylum applications is trending down. In December there were 1026 applications received for asylum. This is down from 1,422 last December
- The main countries of origin for 2024 are: Nigeria (4,037 applications), Jordan (2,877), Pakistan (1,390), Somalia (1,308) and Bangladesh (1,007)
- The number of applications pending in the IPO is beginning to reduce since October 2024. As of December this year there were 22,548 applications pending
- The number of applications in the IPO where a recommendation has been made or otherwise closed off has decreased in December 2024, where 1,105 cases were closed off
- The median time to make a decision for standard cases has begun to trend slowly upwards again, after having shown a downward trend between May 2024 and August 2024. In December 2024 the median processing time to determination was 79.5 weeks (compared to 75 weeks in August 2024 and 85 weeks in October 2024)
- The number of staff in the IPO has gradually been increasing, up to 582 at the end of December 2024
- Of those applications where a decision was made in December by MDU, 45% of decisions were refusals, 4% permission to remain, and 51% were international protection grants

Applications and Main Nationalities



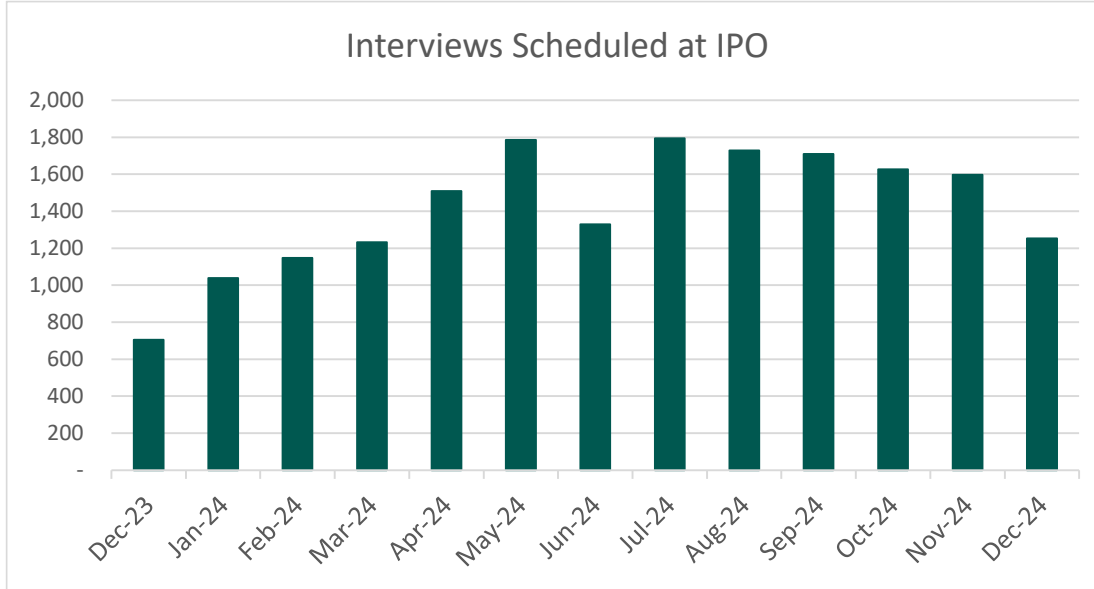
- In December there were 1,026 applications received for asylum. This is down from 1,422 last December. The average number of applications per month between January and December 2024 was 1,547
- For December 2024, the total number of applications included 377 from accelerated procedure (37% of all applicants)
- The main countries of origin for 2024 are: Nigeria (4,037 applications), Jordan (2,877), Pakistan (1,390), Somalia (1,308) and Bangladesh (1,007)

Pending International Protection Applications

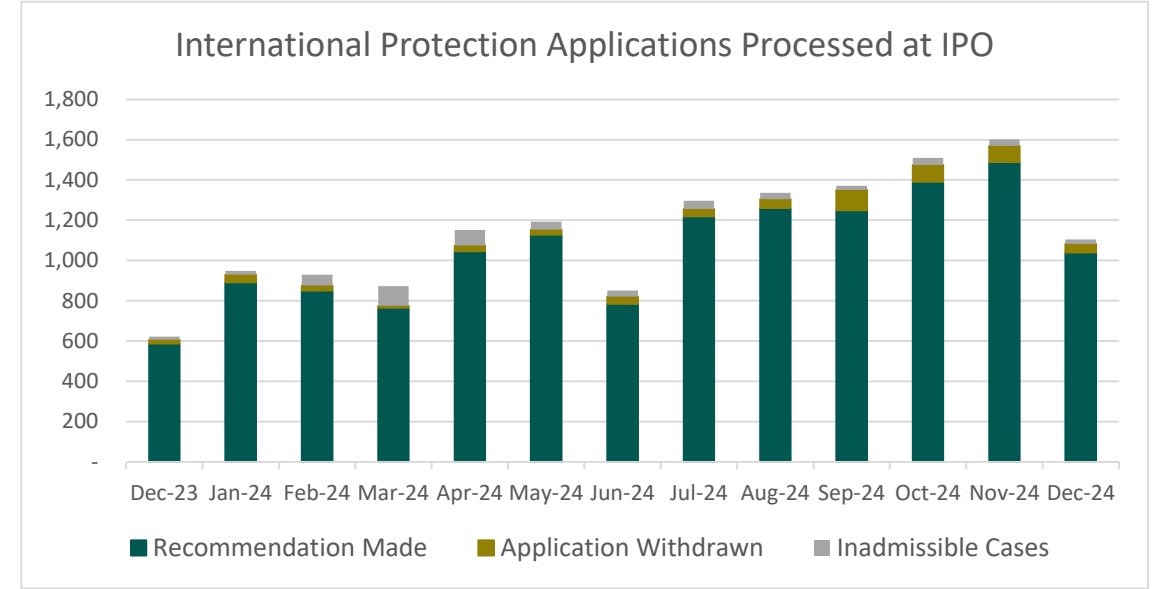


- The number of applications pending in the IPO is 22,548. The numbers have begun to reduce since October 2024 (23,373)
- The number of pending applications for IPAT has been trending upwards. In December 2024, there were 9,243 applications pending
- The pending figure for MDU at the end of December 2024 is 141

International Protection: Interviews and Applications Processed

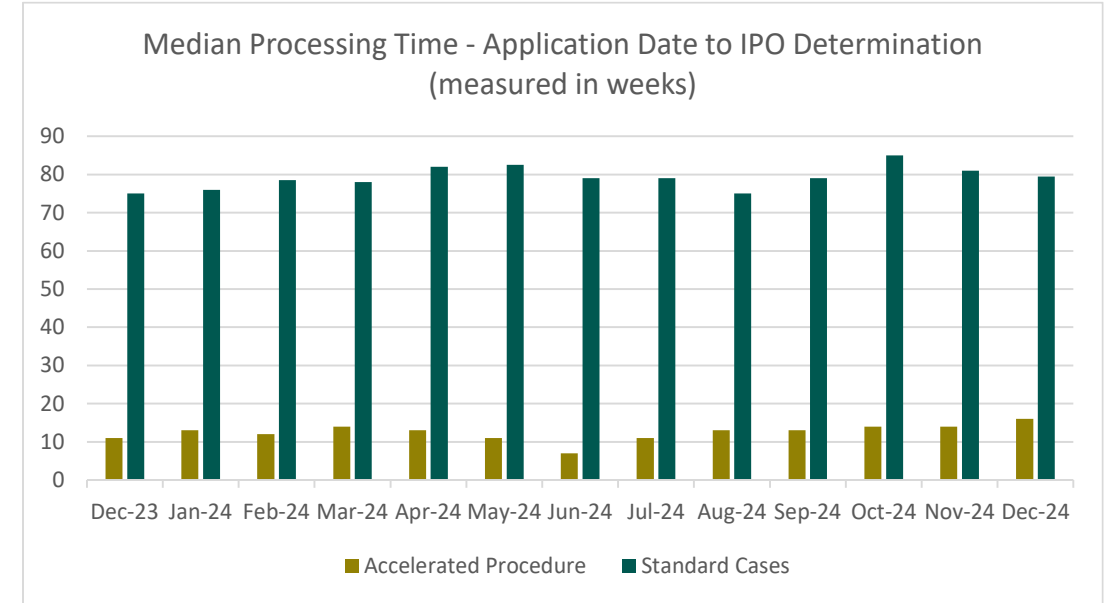
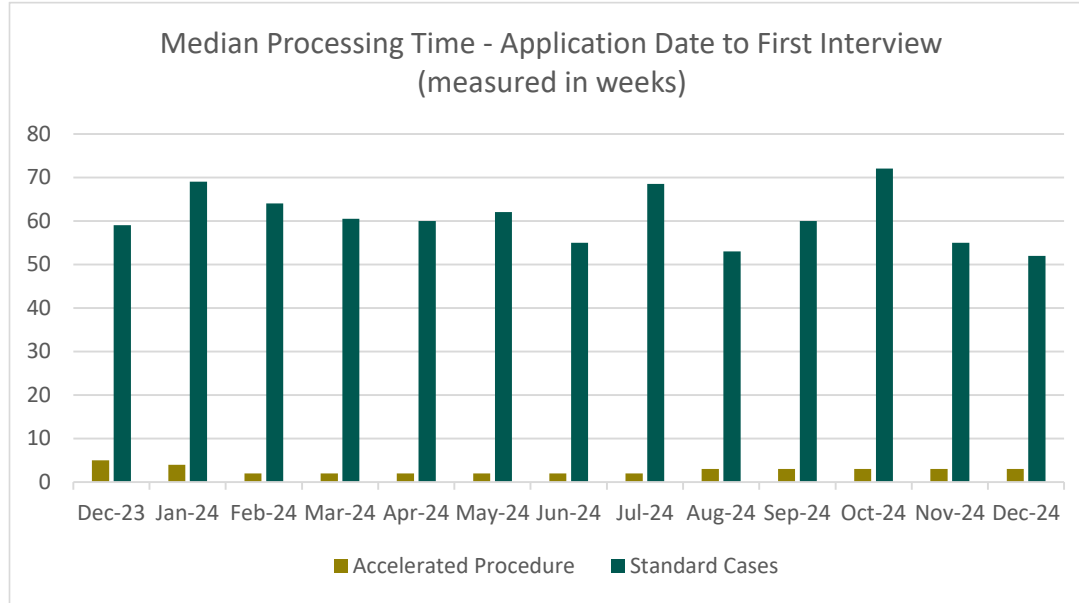


- The number of interviews scheduled at the IPO has been trending down since July 2024
- In December 2024, there were 1,253 interviews scheduled, down from 1,626 in October and down from 1,598 in November
- 2024 interviews scheduled were 17,751 (an 82.1% increase on 9,749 interviews scheduled for 2023)



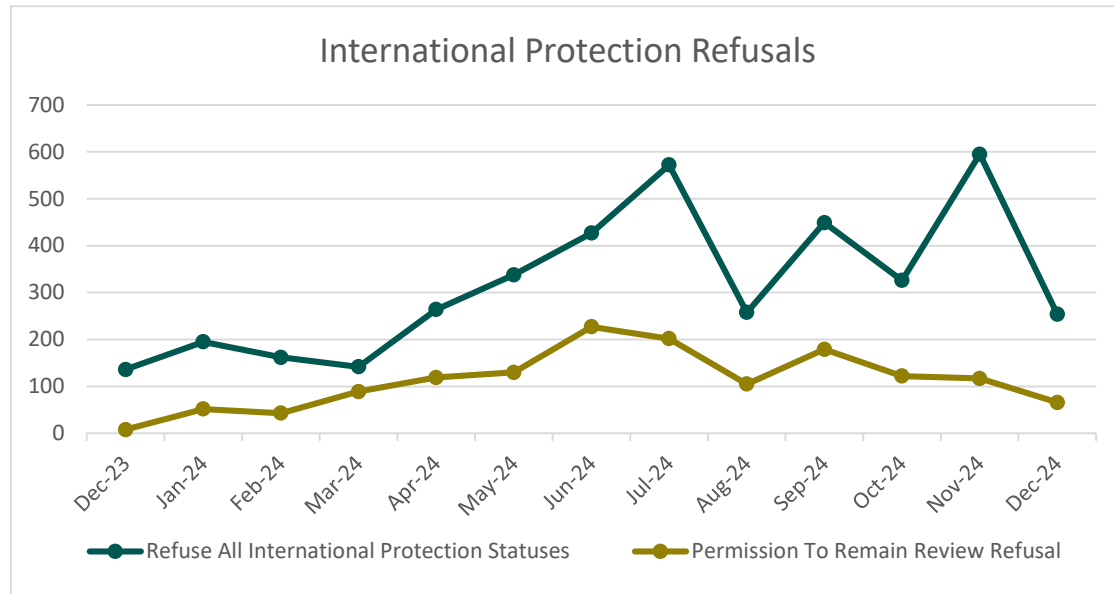
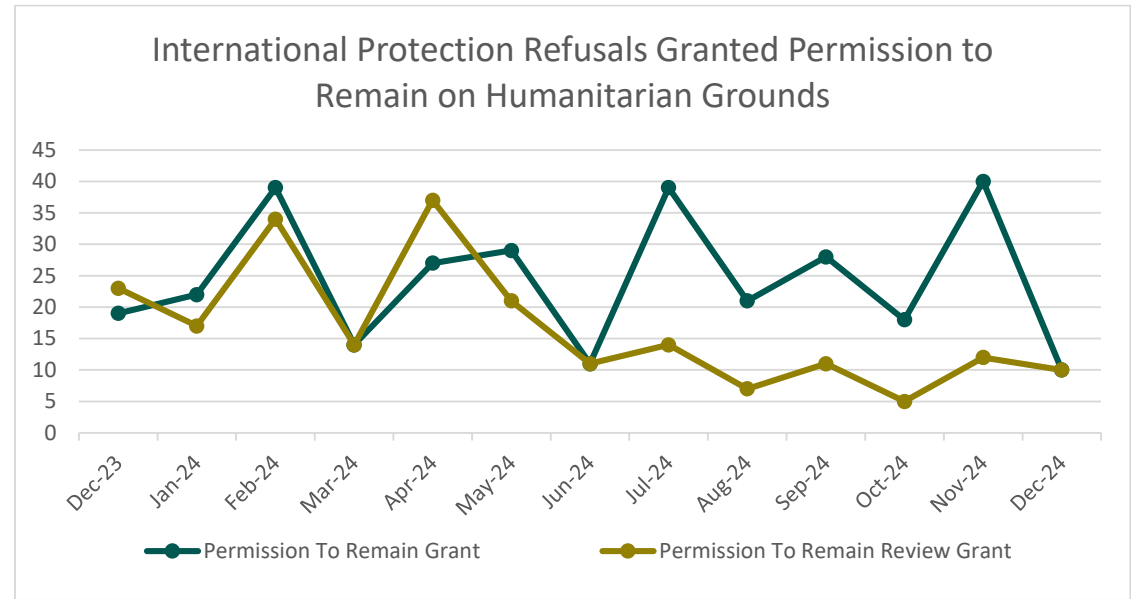
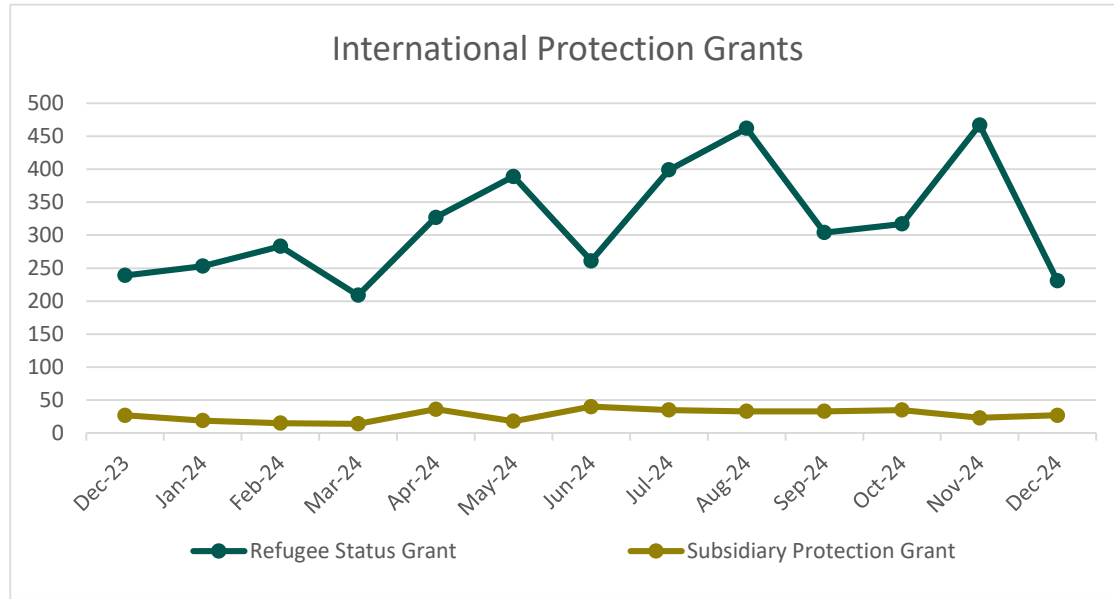
- This table is counting Recommendations Made, Applications Deemed Inadmissible and Applications Withdrawn
- In December 2024, 1,105 cases were closed off. This is down from 1,509 in October and 1,601 in November
- 2024 applications processed were 14,166 (a 59.6% increase on 8,875 applications processed for 2023)

International Protection Applications Processing Times



- Processing times are measured as a median. This represents the middle number in the range of times at hand for processing. The reason why the average is not used is that there are a handful of cases where processing times are long – this would disproportionately impact the average figure and not give a proper representation of processing time
- The median time to the first interview is generally trending downwards. In December 2024, it was 52 weeks for standard cases, down from 72 weeks in October and 55 weeks in November
- For accelerated procedure only cases, the waiting time to the first interview for December was 3 weeks, the same as October and November 2024
- The median processing time to determining an outcome to an asylum application had been slowly increasing since September 2024
- In December 2024, the median processing time to determination for standard cases was 79.5 weeks (down from 85 weeks in October and 81 weeks for November)
- For accelerated procedure only, the median processing time was 16 weeks in December, up from 14 weeks in October and November

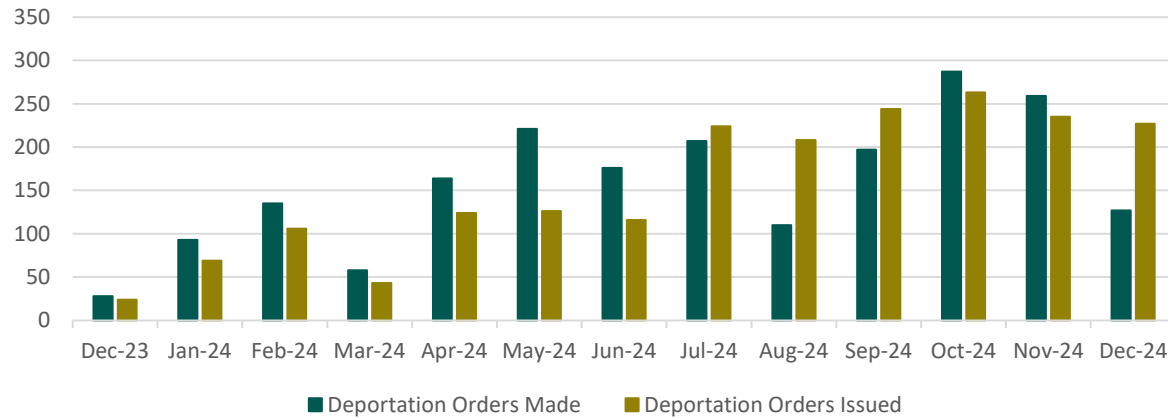
International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused



- In December, of those applications where a decision was made, 231 were given refugee status grant and 27 subsidiary protection grant (258 in total). There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- Of those who were refused refugee status and subsidiary protection, 10 were given Permission to Remain on humanitarian grounds with 10 on a Permission to Remain Review Grant. There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- There were 254 refusals for International Protection Statuses and 66 for Permission to Remain Review
- Overall for December, 45% of decisions were refusals, 4% permission to remain, and 51% were international protection grants

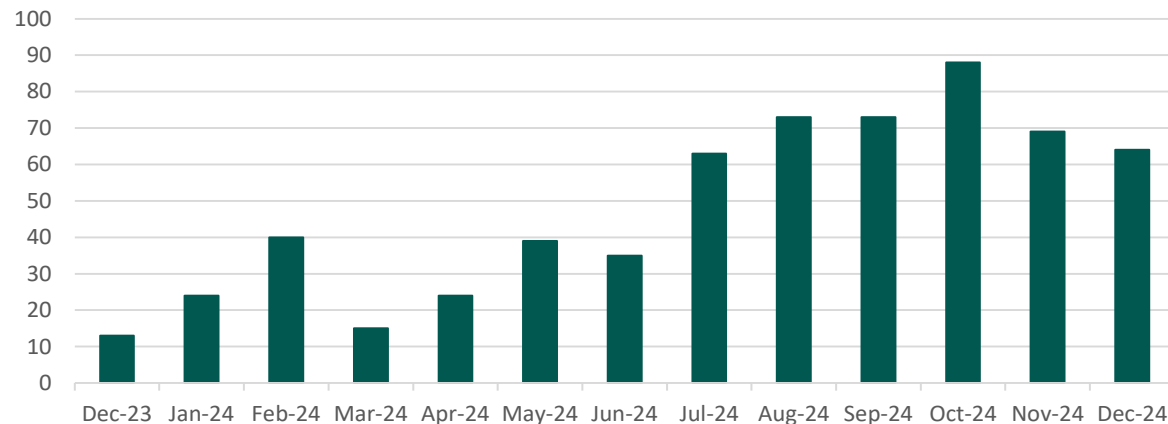
Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

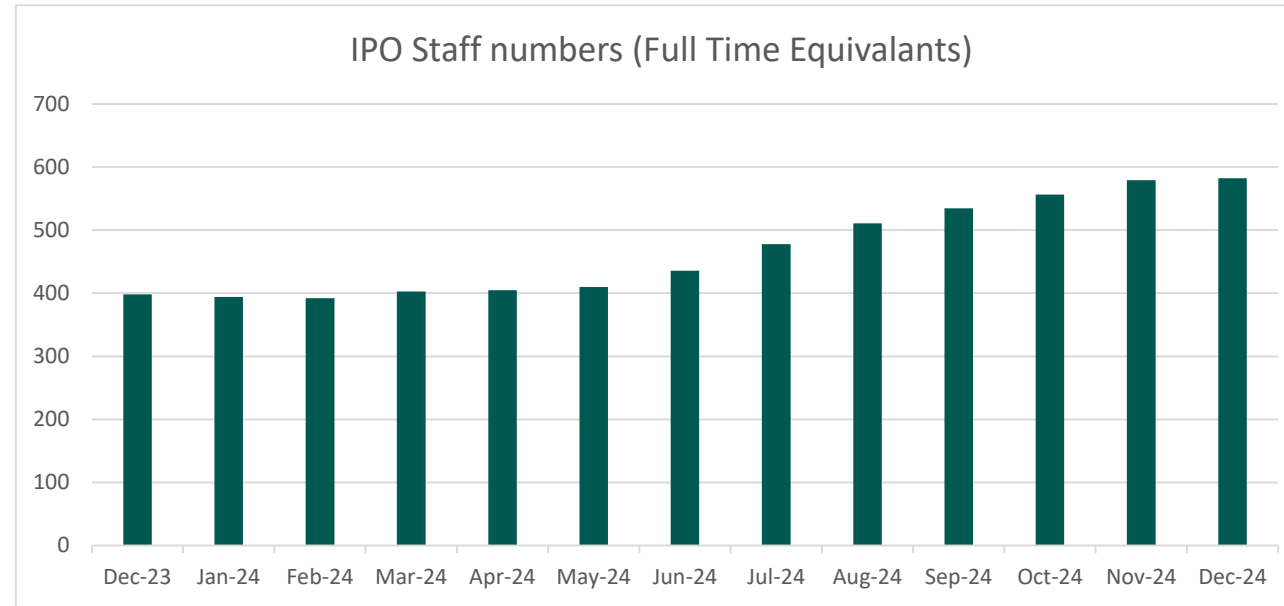


- For December 2024 the number of deportation orders signed (where a person had a previous asylum application) was 127 and the number of deportation orders issued was 227. For November, the figures were 259 and 235 and for October it was 287 and 263, respectively
- For December 2024 the number of removals was 64

Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application



IPO Staff number (Full-Time Equivalents)



- The number of staff in the IPO has gradually been increasing
- In December 2023 there were 398 FTEs in IPO. This number has been slowly trending upwards, to 511 in August 2024 and 556 in October
- At the end of December 2024, the IPO had 582 FTE staff



Appendix

Methodology

Pending International Protection Applications

- IPO – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- IPAT – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- MDU – Data sourced from AISIP. Pending figure does not include legacy cases – the legacy data has been captured in such a way that it cannot be accurately reported on

International Protection: Interviews and Applications Processed

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes

International Protection Applications Processing Times

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- Applicants to whom section 38(5) of the International Protection Act 2015 applies (failure to co-operate) are included in the calculations
- Where an interview took place after a case was reactivated the reactivation date is used as the application date, otherwise the original application date was used for the processing time calculation
- The median calculation is used for processing time at IPO as there are significant outliers in the length of time asylum applications can spend in processing. This is typically due to lengthy procedures such as judicial reviews which are complex and time consuming by their nature, and which are also outside of the remit and control of the IPO during that part of the process. The median is a more accurate measure of the time spent by the IPO in processing applications.

Methodology

International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused

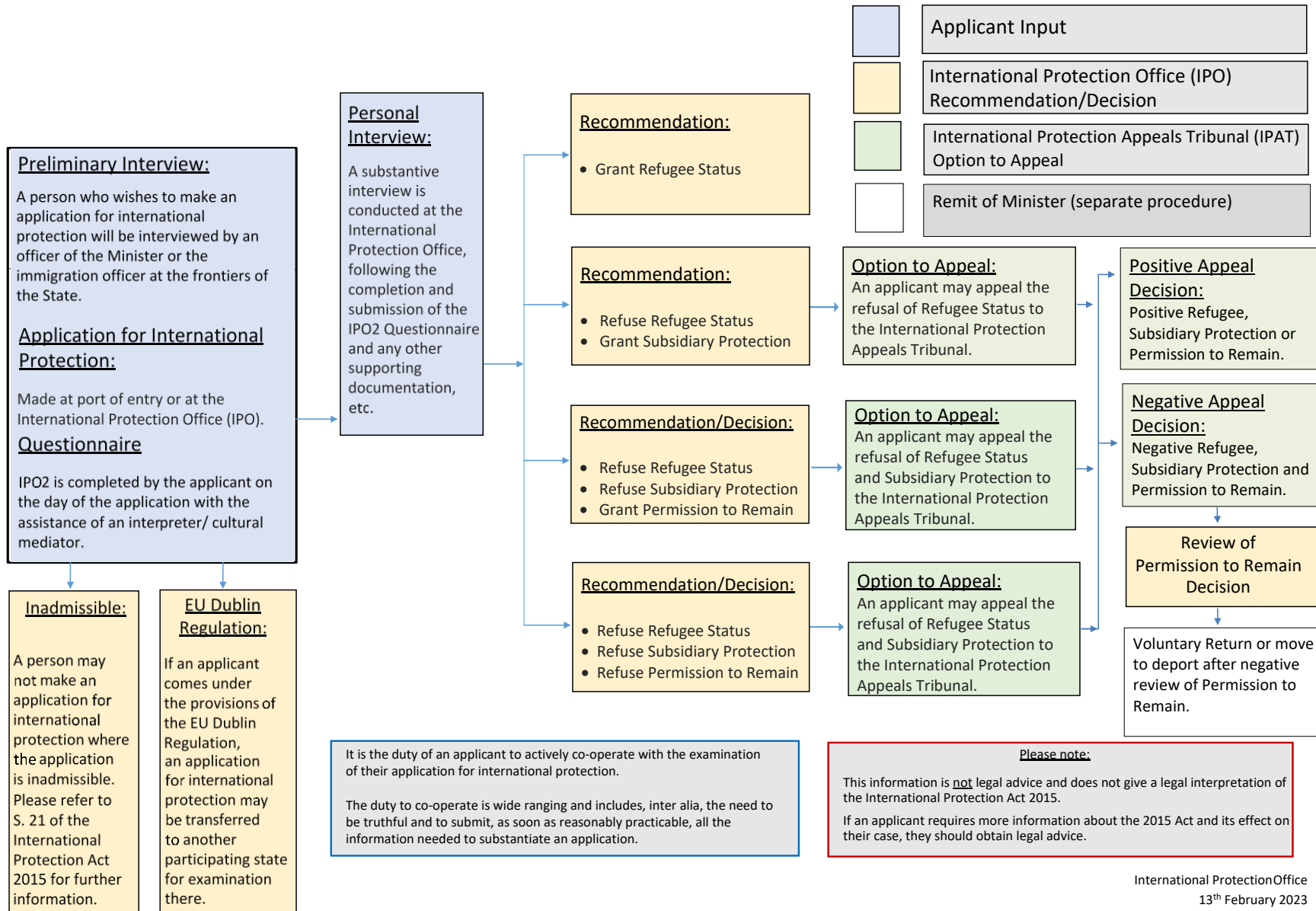
- Quashed decisions and Revocation of Status are not included
- Decision figures include international protection decisions (IPDN) and legacy application types
- Each applicant is represented once in the granted and refused tables
 - For example, if a person is refused refugee status but is granted subsidiary protection they are recorded once in the tables as a subsidiary protection grant. This is to more clearly represent the overall numbers of granted and refused applicants, and to avoid double counting of individuals where they are refused one type of status but are granted another.
- Some of the applicants who have been granted permission to remain are also included in the 'Refuse All International Protection Statuses' category of the refusals table. Permission to remain is a humanitarian permission. In order to be considered for permission to remain you must first have been refused international protection. On slide 7, the 'International Protection Refusals Granted Permission to Remain on Humanitarian Grounds' chart is a combination of applicants still in the asylum process and applicants who have finished the process. The 'International Protection Refusals' chart includes only those applicants who have finished the asylum process.
- Where a revocation occurs the original grant is removed from the figures for the month the permission was originally granted. For example, if an application was granted in January but subsequently revoked later in the year the January figure is updated to remove the grant

Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

- Data for the International Protection Deportation Order (IPDP) application type is sourced from AISIP. All other data is sourced from Lotus Notes

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015



Data Tables (1)

International Protection Office - Applications Received

	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24
Accelerated Procedure	182	186	183	162	374	519	292	417	1,006	922	453	282	377
Standard Cases	1,240	1,588	1,384	1,659	1,649	1,492	1,112	1,318	686	638	599	614	649

International Protection Office – Top 5 Nationality Applications

Top 5 nationalities 2024 to date	Applications	%
Nigeria	4,037	21.7%
Jordan	2,877	15.5%
Pakistan	1,390	7.5%
Somalia	1,308	7.0%
Bangladesh	1,007	5.4%
Other	7,942	42.8%
Total	18,561	

Data Tables (2)

International Protection Office - Pending Applications

	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24
IPO Pending	18,314	19,109	19,719	20,695	21,577	22,419	22,965	23,360	23,727	23,863	23,373	22,641	22,548

International Protection Appeals Tribunal - Pending Applications

	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24
IPAT Pending	3,762	3,949	4,251	4,620	5,110	5,478	5,821	6,257	6,748	7,331	7,990	8,513	9,243

Ministerial Decisions Unit - Pending Applications

	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24
MDU Pending	92	61	59	85	70	119	127	131	106	100	162	176	141

Data Tables (3)

International Protection Office – Interview Scheduled

	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24
Interviews Scheduled	705	1,038	1,148	1,233	1,509	1,785	1,329	1,794	1,729	1,709	1,626	1,598	1,253

International Protection Office – Processed Cases

	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24
Recommendation Made	588	892	851	765	1,046	1,128	784	1,220	1,260	1,249	1,392	1,489	1,039
Application Withdrawn	19	37	25	10	28	25	36	36	44	101	83	81	43
Inadmissible Cases	15	20	54	98	77	40	31	41	32	21	34	31	23

Data Tables (4)

International Protection Office Median Process Time – Application Date to First Interview (measured in weeks)

	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24
Accelerated Procedure	5	4	2	2	2	2	2	2	3	3	3	3	3
Standard Cases	59	69	64	60.5	60	62	55	68.5	53	60	72	55	52

International Protection Office Median Process Time – Application Date to IPO Determination (measured in weeks)

	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24
Accelerated Procedure	11	13	12	14	13	11	7	11	13	13	14	14	16
Standard Cases	75	76	78.5	78	82	82.5	79	79	75	79	85	81	79.5

Data Tables (5)

International Protection Decisions – Grants

	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24
Refugee Status Grant	239	253	283	209	327	389	261	399	462	304	317	467	231
Subsidiary Protection Grant	27	19	15	14	36	18	40	35	33	33	35	23	27
Permission To Remain Grant	19	22	39	14	27	29	11	39	21	28	18	40	10
Permission To Remain Review Grant	23	17	34	14	37	21	11	14	7	11	5	12	10

International Protection Decisions – Refusals

	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24
Refuse All International Protection Statuses	136	195	162	142	264	338	427	572	258	449	326	595	254
Permission To Remain Review Refusal	8	52	43	89	119	130	227	202	105	179	122	117	66

Data Tables (6)

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24
Deportation Orders Made	28	93	135	58	164	221	176	207	110	197	287	259	127
Deportation Orders Issued	24	69	106	43	124	126	116	224	208	244	263	235	227

Deportation Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application

	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24
Enforcement/Returns	13	24	40	15	24	39	35	63	73	73	88	69	64

Data Tables (7)

International Protection Office Staff Numbers (Full-Time Equivalents)

	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24	Sep-24	Oct-24	Nov-24	Dec-24
IPO Staffing Level	398.1	394.1	392.1	402.85	404.85	409.7	435.7	477.7	510.7	534.3	556.3	579.1	582.1